



LEARNING SCIENCE

Spacing: the cheapest upgrade there is

Same problems. Same total time. Very different
result a week later.

Two students, four problems each

Masser

All four in one sitting.

Spacer

Two problems, then two more a week later.

Identical work, different arrangement.



BY THE NUMBERS

74%

What the spacers scored on a test one week after their final practice session.



BY THE NUMBERS

49%

What the massers scored on the same test, having done the same four problems in a single sitting.



Doubling the practice in one sitting bought almost nothing

Two problems in one session scored 46%. Four in one session scored 49%. That gap was not reliable. The spacing gap was.



How to space without building a system

1. Split each set across two days.
2. Scale the gap to the test date.
3. Revisit before it feels comfortable.



What spacing is not

It is not an expanding ladder on fixed days. Across the research, expanding gaps gave no meaningful advantage over equal ones.



Nothing extra to buy, nothing extra to do

The same work, moved. Rohrer and Taylor, 2007.

